well-designed class hierarchy will make for an easier time as you build out functionality. A messily implemented method can be rewritten with impunity provided there's no change to the public interface (that's the beauty of OOP), but a badly designed set of classes is going to cause headaches (and likely be thrown away and rewritten down the road). As the saying goes, weeks of coding can save you days of planning.

We also looked at the SOLID principles, which in turn underpin design patterns. You will find these principles and patterns used everywhere in enterprise-grade PHP software. The most popular frameworks and tools are chock full of strategy-this and mediator-that (often given other names, but if you know the patterns, you'll start spotting them everywhere). If the classes you create adhere to SOLID, then they will stand up to reuse and integrate easily with other code.